
RA and Peer Educator Quick Guide

The Hackles Kit

A free kit by Competence Collective · competencecollective.org · quillsup.org · October 2026

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For resident assistants, orientation leaders, peer mentors and student-success coaches who run a floor meeting, table at an event or get asked for help. Two pages. Read it once, keep it on your phone.

IF A STUDENT DISCLOSES

Know your status before you start. At many colleges RAs and student staff are responsible employees who must pass certain disclosures to the Title IX office. Others are not. Ask your supervisor which you are, and write it here: _____ . [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM; VERIFY current federal rules and your college's policy]

What you are, and are not

YOU ARE A FRIENDLY, trained peer who knows where help is. You are not a counselor, investigator, lawyer or police officer. Your best moves are to listen, give accurate information, and walk someone to the right office.

The routine in one line

HACKLES UP? PAUSE. CHECK. Tell. Notice what is off, wait a few minutes, confirm through a door you opened, and bring in a person.

Running a 30-minute floor meeting

MIN	WHAT
0 to 3	Welcome. Say the heads-up: "I am happy to listen. If you tell me something personal, here is what I may have to share."
3 to 8	One short story from the cards (Session 1 or Session 4). Read the card aloud. Nobody plays the sender.
8 to 20	Small groups: What raised our hackles? What would we check? Who would we tell?
20 to 27	Share out. Add the first-hour list: bank, passwords starting with email, keep messages, tell someone, report.
27 to 30	Hand out the Campus Safety Card. Point to one office.

GOOD CARD CHOICES FOR floor meetings: 1A (job offer), 1B (apartment), 1C (bursar text), 2B (code and caller), 4A (voice message).

Things you can do

- Share the Campus Safety Card and the first-hour list.
- Walk a resident to [IT HELP DESK], [FINANCIAL AID OFFICE], [COUNSELING CENTER] or [CAMPUS POLICE].
- Sit with a resident while they call their bank or the platform.
- Check in after a week.
- Say "I do not know. Let's find out together."

Things you should not do

- Do not look at someone's phone, messages or images.
- Do not ask to see an image. Never copy, forward or screenshot an image of a person under 18.
- Do not contact the person who is harassing or threatening a resident.
- Do not promise secrecy or outcomes.
- Do not run "mock hacking" or tracking demos. This module teaches defence only.
- Do not give legal, medical or immigration advice.
- Do not post about a resident's situation, even without a name.

If a resident tells you something serious

1. **Heads-up first.** "Thank you. Before you go on, I want to tell you what I can and cannot keep private. [I may have to share this with the Title IX office.] If you would like a confidential person, I can walk you to [COUNSELING CENTER]."
2. **Listen and believe.** "Thank you for telling me. This is not your fault."
3. **Ask what they need.** "Are you safe right now? What would help most today?"
4. **Offer choices.** Counseling, an advocate, the Title IX office, campus police, a platform report, or nothing today.
5. **Safety.** Danger now: 911 or [CAMPUS POLICE]. Thoughts of suicide: stay, ask directly, 988 (call or text 988), Crisis Text Line (text HOME to 741741), [COUNSELING CENTER].
6. **Hand off, and report as your duty requires** (for example, to [TITLE IX OFFICE] or [RESIDENCE LIFE SUPERVISOR]). Tell the resident what you are doing before you do it.
7. **Write down** what was said and what you did, as policy requires. Do not share it with friends.
8. **Look after yourself.** Talk with your supervisor. You do not have to carry it alone.

Common questions

A RESIDENT SAYS	YOU COULD SAY
"I think I got scammed. I paid \$300."	"Thank you for telling me. Let's call your bank together. Then we can change your email password and report it at reportfraud.ftc.gov ."
"Someone is threatening to share my pictures."	Heads-up, then: "This is not your fault. Do not pay and do not delete anything yet. Let's save the messages and get you to [COUNSELING CENTER]. StopNCII.org and the platform report forms are options."
"My ex keeps making new accounts to message me."	"That is not okay. Let's write down the dates and accounts. [TITLE IX OFFICE] and [CAMPUS POLICE] can explain options. You decide what to do."
"My partner wants my passcode. Is that normal?"	"Sharing is a choice. If you feel pressure, you can talk with [COUNSELING CENTER] or loveisrespect (1-866-331-9474, text LOVEIS to 22522) [VERIFY]."
"Can I use AI on my paper?"	"It depends on the course. Check the syllabus, and email your instructor to ask."

Your local card

CONTACT	NUMBER OR PLACE
Campus police	
Counseling center	
Title IX office	
Dean of students	
IT help desk	
My supervisor	

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Hackles has not been evaluated in a controlled study.*